

WHY ANALYTICS?

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

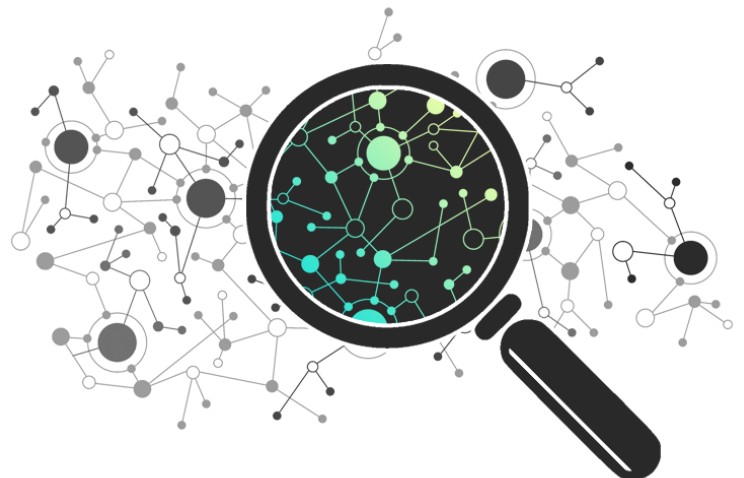
WHY ANALYTICS?

THE WORLD **RUNS ON DATA**

Data is *everywhere*, but without analytics it's just numbers and noise; the analysts' role is to translate **raw information** into **insights and outcomes**

Reasons to work in Data Analytics:

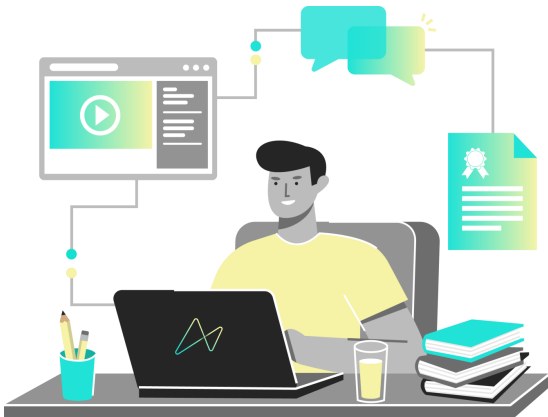
- ✓ High average salary and job satisfaction
- ✓ Strong and growing demand for talent
- ✓ Highly versatile and transferrable skills
- ✓ Wide range of roles and specialties
- ✓ Unique blend of creative + analytical thinking
- ✓ Opportunity to make a **real impact**, at any level



*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

DATA ANALYST JOB INSIGHTS

Data is playing an increasingly central and critical role in the business world; as companies seek to make better data-driven decisions, **demand for analytics talent is on the rise**



\$73,847

Avg. Analyst Salary

Based on data from indeed.com

47,885

US Job Openings

Based on data from LinkedIn (June 2021)

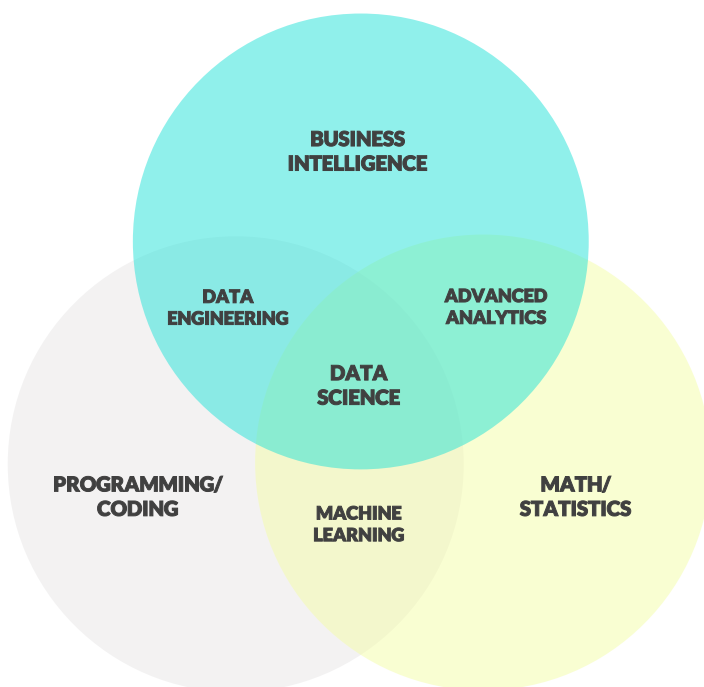
4.2/5

Avg. Job Satisfaction

Based on data from payscale.com

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

FLAVORS OF ANALYTICS



THIS IS

DATA ANALYTICS

Many types of roles fall under the larger analytics umbrella, but they are all about **using data to make smart decisions**.

The differences come down to the **types of problems** you are trying to solve, and the **types of tools** you are using to solve them.

BI + DATA SCIENCE

BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

- Typically focused on **Descriptive Analytics**: *What happened, why did it happen, how can we learn from it?*
- Often deals with **specific, known questions**: *Why are sales declining? Which products drive the highest ROI?*
- Emphasis on self-service **database, analytics & visualization** tools (Excel, SQL, Power BI, Tableau, etc.)
- Designed to deal with **static, structured** data sources (tabular datasets & pre-planned relational models)
- GOAL: **identify patterns & trends** to turn data into insight
- Deliverables tend to be **visuals, reports & dashboards**



DATA SCIENCE

- Typically focused on **Predictive & Prescriptive Analytics**: *What will happen in the future, how can we prepare for it?*
- Often deals with **unknowns**: *Which employees are likely to churn? Which product will a customer purchase next?*
- Emphasis on **statistics & programming** tools designed for flexibility and agility (R, Python, open-source libraries, etc.)
- Can be used to deal with **high-velocity, structured or unstructured** data (text, audio, images, IoT signals, etc.)
- GOAL: **test hypotheses** through experimentation & iteration
- Deliverables tend to be **algorithms & statistical models**

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

FINDING YOUR PATH

BI ANALYST

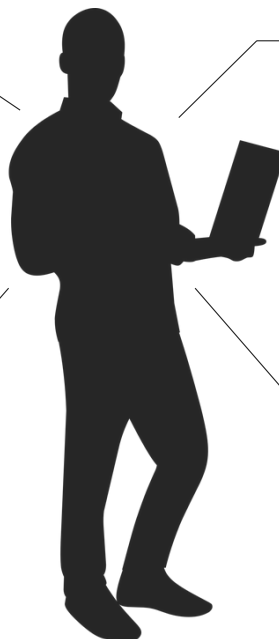
A **Business Intelligence** or **Data Analyst** role may be a good fit if you:

- Love analyzing data for insights and convincing stakeholders to act
- Enjoy solving a wide variety of business cases and open-ended tasks
- Want to build a deep skillset, from data engineering to analysis and visualization

DATA VIZ SPECIALIST

A **Data Visualization Specialist** role may be a good fit if you:

- Love designing visuals to tell stories and bring data to life
- Want to flex both your creative and critical thinking skills
- Prefer working with prepared data and under specific project guidelines



DATA ENGINEER

A **Data Engineer** or **Database Admin (DBA)** role may be a good fit if you:

- Enjoy building data infrastructure and engineering database systems
- Prefer concrete technical tasks over open-ended business cases
- Would rather build and design databases than perform visual or exploratory analysis

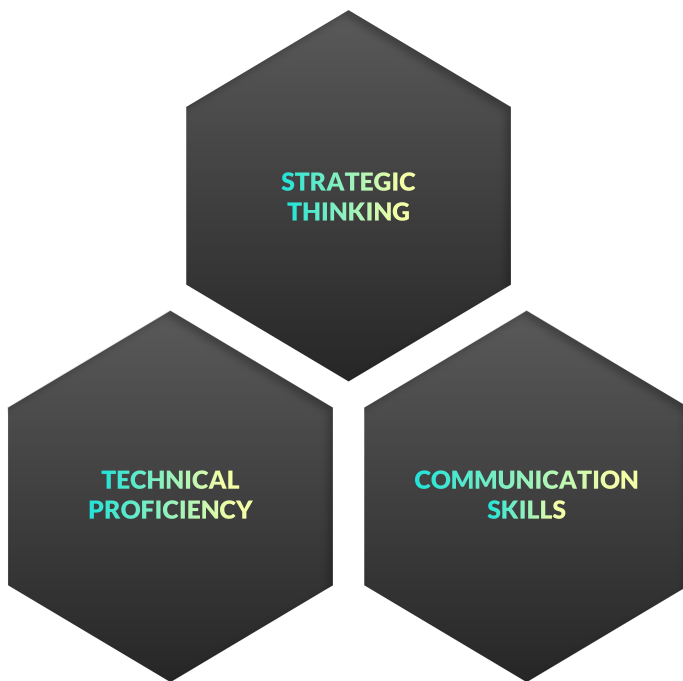
DATA SCIENTIST

A **Data Science** or **Machine Learning** role may be a good fit if you:

- Love to program and write code
- Enjoy math and statistics
- Can distill complex topics and communicate them clearly
- Prefer one-off projects over dashboard design or performance reporting

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

THE ANALYTICS TRIFECTA



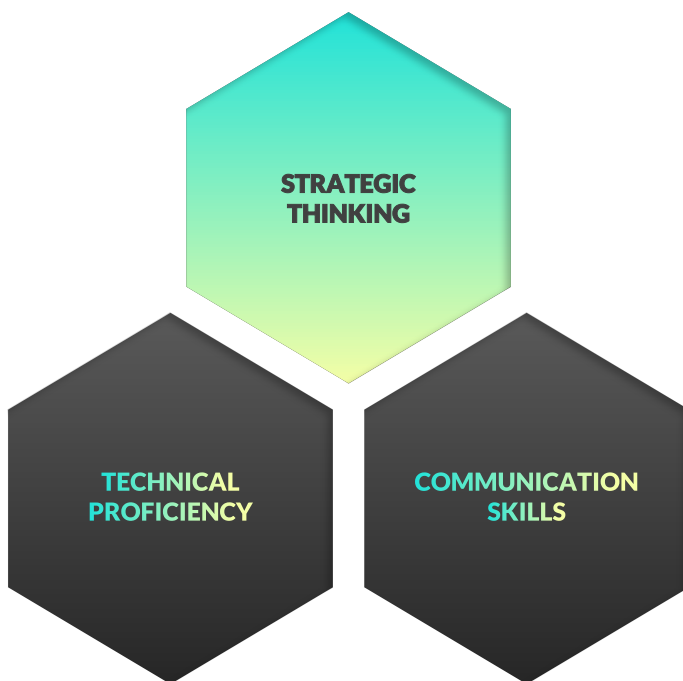
When we think about what separates a good analyst from a *great* one, the following three attributes come to mind:

1. **Strategic thinking**
2. **Technical proficiency**
3. **Communication skills**

We call this the “**Analytics Trifecta**”, because it represents the three core skills which can help you produce exceptional results at every stage of the workflow.

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

THE ANALYTICS TRIFECTA



STRATEGIC THINKING

The ability to **think strategically** is critical, especially during the early stages of the analytics workflow.

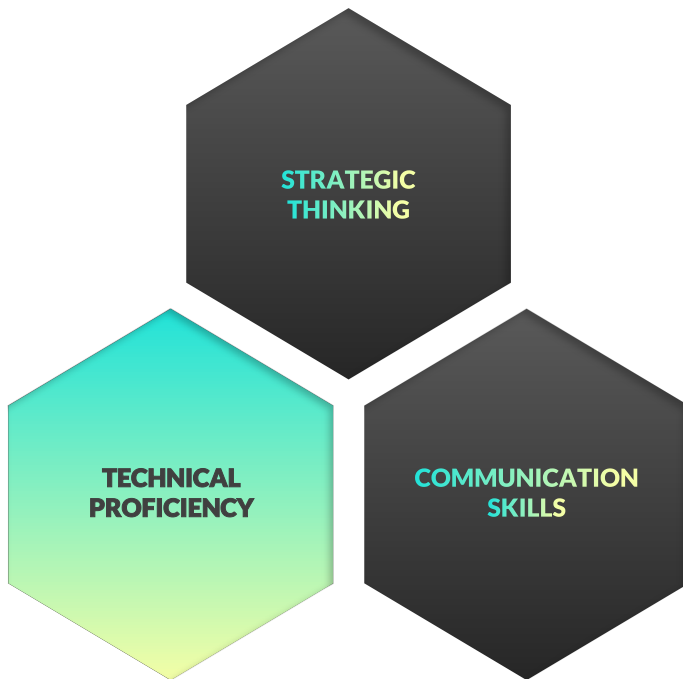
Strategic thinking is about understanding business goals or pain points, identifying key factors for success or failure, and designing clear, tactical analyses and measurement plans to drive desired outcomes.



PRO TIP: Nothing beats real-world experience, but reading business case studies can be a great way to develop your strategic thinking skills!

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

THE ANALYTICS TRIFECTA



TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Simply put, technical proficiency is the **ability to execute**, whether that's writing code, building ETL pipelines, or designing data visualizations or dashboards.

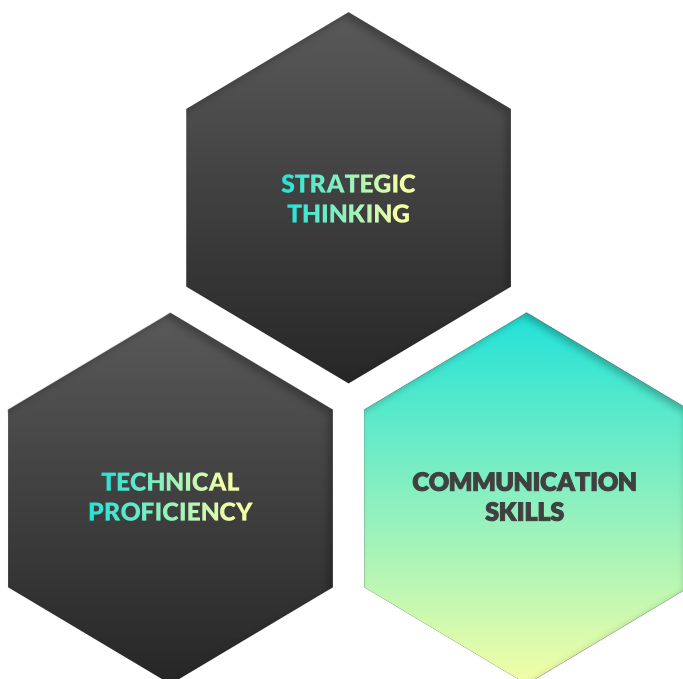
Strong, well-rounded technical skills allow you to contribute to a broader range of analytics projects, work efficiently, and clearly showcase (*and show off!*) your skills.



PRO TIP: Most people focus too much on building technical skills and too little on strategic thinking or communication; find a balance!

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

THE ANALYTICS TRIFECTA



COMMUNICATION SKILLS

Analysts essentially act as the translators between raw data and end users, so your ability to **communicate clearly** is essential to your success.

This includes *all* forms of outbound communication (written, visual, verbal, non-verbal) as well as the ability to listen and interpret feedback effectively.



PRO TIP: People respond to *stories*, not data points; always aim to create a clear narrative to engage users and drive towards the key insights

*Copyright Maven Analytics, LLC

KEY TAKEAWAYS



Demand for analytics talent is strong, **and on the rise**

- *Data is playing an increasingly critical role in business, and analysts are the ones who give it meaning*



Data Analytics skills are **powerful and versatile**

- *Analysis and visualization skills can immediately add value to virtually any company working with data*



All analytics roles are ultimately about making **smart, data-driven decisions**

- *There are many specialties or “flavors” of analytics, but they share many of the same core skills*



Strategic, technical, and communication skills are **equally important**

- *Aim to build a “trifecta” of skills: strategic thinking, technical proficiency, and clear communication*